

1. Evidence & attribution

Definition:

Is this grounded in verifiable evidence, and does it cite sources clearly?

Factors:

A: Explicitly names primary source (e.g., an official, a named witness, or a specific organization by name).

B: Includes or links direct evidence (e.g., data table, official document, transcript, direct quote longer than one sentence).

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: doesn't satisfy any of the factors ("it's being said. . .")

Rate 2: only one factor is present

Rate 3: both factors are present

2. Uncertainty signaling

Definition:

Does the item communicate that facts are evolving?

Factors:

A (Verbal hedging): Uses specific epistemic markers to indicate evolving facts (e.g., "reportedly," "allegedly," "unconfirmed," "police are investigating," "story is evolving").

B (Explicit Limitations): Includes sentence/paragraph explicitly stating what is known and not known or acknowledges conflicting accounts.

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: Definitive/authoritative tone with no hedging.

Rate 2: Factor A exists, but doesn't detail the limits of knowledge.

Rate 3: Both A and B exists—verbal hedging and explicitly defines unknowns.

3. Context completeness

Definition:

How much background/timeline does it provide?

Factors:

A (Temporal depth): Provides a timeline of events leading up to the crisis.

B (Stakeholder perspectives): Mentions at least two groups or viewpoints involved in the events and/or its aftermath.

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: Doesn't satisfy any of the factors. Fragmented/clip-level reporting of the now.

Rate 2: Provides either A(a timeline) or B(an analysis of at least two stakeholders/two groups of stakeholders involved).

Rate 3: Provides both A and B.

4. Affective intensity / outrage language

Definition:

Emotional arousal that tends to drive engagement.

Factor:

A (Moral emotional language): Uses “loaded” adjectives or adverbs that trigger moral judgement (e.g., shocking, disgusting, heroic, shameful, common sense). Can include quotes.

B (Sensationalized Punctuation): Use non-standard formatting to drive arousal (e.g., All caps, exclamation points)

- Daily Mail and BBC will include Social Media posts

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: Neutral, matter-of-fact reporting.

Rate 2: Use of Factor A (moral-emotional language) but no Factor B.

Rate 3: Has both factor A and B/

5. Conflict framing

Definition:

Polarization fuel (“us vs them,” blame, antagonistic group framing).

Factor:

A (Antagonistic Grouping): Categorizes people into “us vs. them” groups. This does NOT include stating that there are multiple stakeholders/groups; instead, there must be a clear bias in which group is favored.

B (Blame): Frames the event as a win-lose scenario where one group is explicitly blamed for negative outcomes. Can include quotes.

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: Neither factor A nor factor B. Focuses on the event without assigning group-based blame. It is written from a neutral perspective.

Rate 2: Factor A exists, but not Factor B. Some “us vs them” framing, but no blame assigned to one group.

Rate 3: Both Factor A and Factor B. Strong adversarial framing. Assigned blame to one group directly.

6. Call to action/mobilization

Definition:

Does it push behavior rather than understanding?

Factor:

A (Instructional Verbs): **Author** directs readers to perform a task (e.g., Share this, Watch,).

B (Physical mobilization): **Author** encourages behavior outside of a digital platform(e.g., Protest, boycott, donate, vote for [candidate]).

Scoring Logic:

Rate 1: Neither factor A nor B. No call to physical action. Condemnations & changes in attitude are not sufficient to count as calls to action.

Rate 2: Factor A or B. Call for digital engagement and/or awareness.

Rate 3: Factor A and B. Explicit mobilization. Push for political or social action.